

Madison Levine

Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

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Education

University of Illinois	2022–Present
Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics (Expected 2027)	
<i>Fields:</i> Development Economics, Behavioral Economics	
<i>Secondary:</i> Risk and Uncertainty, Agricultural Economics	
University of San Francisco	2019
M.S., International and Development Economics	
Saint Mary’s College of California	2017
B.A., Economics	

Publications

- [1] N.F. Meriggi, M. Voors, **M. Levine**, et al. [Last-Mile Delivery Increases Vaccine Uptake in Sierra Leone](#). *Nature*, 627: 612–619, 2024.
- [2] **M. Levine**, N.F. Meriggi, A.M. Mobarak, V. Ramakrishna, M. Voors, and U. Wadehra. [Gendered Disparities during the COVID-19 Crisis in Sierra Leone](#). *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 113: 567–571, 2023.
- [3] J.S. Solis Arce, S.S. Warren, N.F. Meriggi, **M. Levine**, et al. [COVID-19 Vaccine Acceptance and Hesitancy in Low- and Middle-Income Countries](#). *Nature Medicine*, 27: 1385–1394, 2021.

Working Papers

Job Market Paper

Loss Aversion and Agricultural Investment: Experimental Evidence from Smallholder Farmers in Kenya
(with Sarah Janzen, Berber Kramer, and Kelvin Shikuku)

Abstract: Coming soon.

See It Grow: A Randomized Evaluation of a Digital Innovation to Improve Crop Insurance Contract Design
(with Berber Kramer, Francesco Cecchi, and Lilian Waithaka)
[CGIAR Discussion Paper \(2025\)](#)

Work in Progress

Policymakers’ Preferences for Pre-Arranged Financing: Evidence from Disaster Risk Financing Experiments in Africa
(with Berber Kramer et al.)

Research Experience

Consultant, International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI)	Oct 2025–Feb 2026
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Nairobi, Kenya (in residence)
with Berber Kramer and Ruth Hill

Graduate Research Fellow, International Livestock Research Institute Jan 2025–Jun 2025

Nairobi, Kenya (in residence)

Supervisor: Kelvin Shikuku

Research Assistant, University of Illinois 2024–2025

with Sarah Janzen

Senior Research Associate, Wageningen University & Research 2019–2022

Freetown, Sierra Leone (in residence)

with Niccolò Meriggi, Ahmed Mushfiq Mobarak, and Maarten Voors

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Microeconomics (ACE 300), University of Illinois Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, World Food Economy (ACE 251), University of Illinois Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Microeconomics, University of San Francisco 2018–2019

Presentations and Invited Seminars

See It Grow: A Randomized Evaluation of a Digital Innovation to Improve Crop Insurance Contract Design, Midwest International Economic Development Conference, 2026

Impacts of risk transfer on agricultural investments: A randomized trial on insurance contract design in Kenya, AAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

Loss Aversion and Agricultural Investment: Experimental Evidence from Smallholder Farmers in Kenya, AAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

Demand for Risk Management Tools, ACRE Africa, 2025

Grants and Awards

Best Second Year Paper Award, University of Illinois 2024

Global Food Security Graduate Fellowship, University of Illinois 2024
 \$6,720

Graduate Student International Research Grant, University of Illinois 2024
 \$4,000

Skills

Programming: Stata (proficient), Python (intermediate), R (intermediate)

Tools: L^AT_EX, Android Studio, Flutter, QGIS

Survey Platforms: SurveyCTO, ODK, Survey Solutions, Kobo

Languages: English (native), Spanish (intermediate)

References

Sarah Janzen (Chair)
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Berber Kramer
 Senior Research Fellow
 IFPRI
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Hope Michelson
 Professor
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Nick Paulson
 Professor
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